

SOCAL ATTACKS FOILED, FEDS SAY

Four are arrested, accused of plotting to bomb businesses on New Year's Eve.

By Grace Toohey

A plan to attack several Los Angeles-area businesses on New Year's Eve was detailed, dangerous and already in motion, authorities said.

But as four people allegedly tied to a left-wing, antigovernment group gathered last week in the Mojave Desert to make and test several test bombs, FBI officials say, agents were able to foil the terror plot.

"They had everything they needed to make an operational bomb at that location," First Assistant U.S. Atty. Bill Essayli said at a news conference Monday morning. "We disrupted this terror plot before buildings were demolished or innocent people were killed."

The four people were arrested on suspicion of devising a plot that Essayli called "organized, sophisticated and extremely violent." They all were tied to what officials described as a radical faction of the Turtle Island Liberation Front called Order of the Black Lotus. FBI Assistant Director in Charge Akil Davis called the faction "a violent, homegrown, antigovernment group."

Officials wouldn't name the businesses or buildings the group allegedly planned to target, but Essayli said they were various "logistic centers" similar to ones that Amazon might have. He said they were located in Los Angeles and Orange counties.

A criminal complaint charged Audrey Illeene Carroll, 30, and Dante Gaffield, 24, of Los Angeles; Zachary Aaron Page, 32, of Torrance; and Tina Lai, 41, of Glendale, with conspiracy and possession of an unregistered destructive device. Their attorneys either did not immediately respond to inquiries or declined to comment.

According to the complaint, the group shared a handwritten document called "Operation Midnight Sun." The plan, authorities said, was to plant backpacks with improvised explosive devices at five locations targeting two U.S. companies to be "simultaneously detonated" at midnight on New Year's Eve.

Federal authorities said members of the group shared the document in November. It detailed assembling "complex pipe bombs," including instructions to manufacture the devices and "guidance to avoid leaving evidence behind that could be traced back" to the group, the complaint said.

FBI officials continued to track the group until Dec. 12, when the suspects traveled to a location near Twenty-nine Palms with "bomb-making materials" and plans to construct and test the devices, the complaint [See Arrests, A7]



DAVID LIVINGSTON Getty Images



SIDNEY BALDWIN Castle Rock Entertainment

PROLIFIC FILMMAKER

Rob Reiner, at top, with his wife and frequent collaborator, Michele Singer Reiner, in 2012. Above, on the set of his 1996 film "Ghosts of Mississippi." In 1993 he was nominated for a best picture Academy Award for "A Few Good Men."

ROB REINER, 1947 – 2025

Director of iconic films was a force in state politics

By Christie D'Zurilla and Seema Mehta

In the world that Rob Reiner built, amplifiers went "up to 11." People readily ordered "what she's having." Courtrooms couldn't "handle the truth," comedy and drama traded places seamlessly and liberal ideals born in the 1960s and '70s formed the gold standard of politics.

A writer, director, pro-

ducer, actor and political activist whose career in Hollywood spanned more than six decades and included some of the most iconic titles in movie history, Reiner was found dead Sunday afternoon with his wife, Michele Singer Reiner, at the home they shared in Brentwood. He was 78.

Reiner's middle child, Nick, 32, was taken into custody Sunday night and booked early Monday morning on suspicion of double

murder, police said. With a long history of drug addiction, Nick had been living in the guesthouse on the Reiner property.

"It is with profound sorrow that we announce the tragic passing of Michele and Rob Reiner," a spokesperson for the family said in a statement Sunday. "We are heartbroken by this sudden loss, and we ask for privacy during this unbelievably difficult time."

[See Reiner, A5]

Rob Reiner's son arrested in parents' deaths

The men argued the night before director's and wife's bodies were found, friends say.

By Richard Winton, Matthew Ormseth, Clara Harter, Hannah Fry and Grace Toohey

Rob Reiner's son Nick was arrested on suspicion of murdering his parents after the Hollywood legend and his wife, Michele Singer Reiner, were found dead at their Brentwood home Sunday.

Los Angeles Police Chief Jim McDonnell said that officers responded to the Reiner home about 3:40 p.m. Detectives from the elite Robbery-Homicide Division "worked throughout the night" and took Nick Reiner, 32, into custody.

"Our hearts go out to the

family and friends of the Reiners," McDonnell said at a news conference Monday, calling the situation "a tragic incident."

Authorities have issued a search warrant for the Reiner home, McDonnell said, adding that it's a "critical piece of our investigation."

Rob Reiner, who starred as "Meathead" in the sitcom "All in the Family" and whose hits as a director included the cultural touchstones "When Harry Met Sally," "The Princess Bride" and "This Is Spinal Tap," was 78. Michele Singer Reiner, a photographer and producer, was 70.

News of the killings sent shock waves across Hollywood and the country's political establishment. Rob Reiner was also a leading political voice, campaigning for liberal causes such as gay marriage.

Former President Clin- [See Investigation, A4]

AN APPRECIATION

In forging own path, he spoke to us all

Amy Nicholson
Film Critic

Over his five-decade career, Rob Reiner — who was found dead Sunday at his Brentwood home along with his wife, Michele — never stayed put, roving from music spoofs ("This Is Spinal Tap") to horror movies ("Misery"), political thrillers ("A Few Good Men") to coming-of-age dramas ("Stand by Me") and romantic comedies both glibly teenaged ("The Sure Thing") and bracingly adult ("When Harry Met Sally..."). Reiner bobbed and weaved and, in the process of entertaining himself, directed at least one of everyone's favorite movies.

If I were marooned on an

island and could bring only one film from the entire history of Hollywood, I'd choose Reiner's 1987 adventure "The Princess Bride." That swashbuckler perfectly executes each of the above genres — and fantasy, too. It's everything you'd want from the movies in one title, all in under 100 minutes.

And those are just Reiner's first seven movies, a string of excellence that deserves a toast bigger than the 20 bottles of Beaujolais Nouveau he witnessed Andre the Giant drink in one day on the set of "The Princess Bride."

More than Reiner's success, however, I want to salute him as an artist who chose creative risks over easy money. He continually [See Appreciation, A4]

Son's struggles: Nick Reiner and his father talked openly about his drug addiction. **CALIFORNIA, B1**
Empathetic lens: A look at Rob Reiner's directorial legacy as well as his 10 best films. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

U.S., Ukraine narrow differences over security



LISI NIESNER Pool Photo

PRESIDENT Volodymyr Zelensky and U.S. envoy Steve Witkoff gather for a group photo in Berlin.

By Stefanie Dazio and Aamer Madhani

BERLIN — The U.S. agreed to provide unspecified security guarantees to Ukraine as part of a peace deal to end Russia's nearly four-year war, and more talks are likely this weekend, U.S. officials said Monday after the latest discussions with President Volodymyr Zelensky in Berlin.

The officials said talks with President Trump's envoys, Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, led to narrowing differences on security guar-

antees that Kyiv said must be provided, as well as on Moscow's demand that Ukraine concede land in the Donbas region in the country's east.

Trump dialed into a dinner Monday evening with negotiators and European leaders, and more talks are expected this weekend in Miami or elsewhere in the United States, according to the U.S. officials, who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to comment publicly by the White House.

"I think we're closer now than we have been, ever,"

Trump told reporters at an unrelated White House event. He added, "We're having tremendous support from European leaders. They want to get it ended, also."

The U.S. officials said the offer of security guarantees won't be on the table "forever." They said the Trump administration plans to put forward the agreement on guarantees for Senate approval, although they didn't specify whether it would be ratified like a treaty, which needs the chamber's two-thirds approval.

[See Peace, A3]

The youths left behind by DACA

By Itzel Luna

Alex immigrated to the U.S. as a toddler and has long felt haunted by his undocumented status.

In 2017, when he turned 15, he was finally old enough to apply for the Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals program, only for it to slip from his grasp right before he started the paperwork, when it was rescinded by the Trump administration.

Then, in 2020, Alex was set to graduate at the top of his class and had racked up a slew of college acceptances, including a full ride to Har-

vard University. He ultimately declined because of his status, worried about travel restrictions. Instead, he enrolled in a nearby University of California campus.

"It was almost like the system was taunting me," said Alex, who is now a Cal State University graduate student and chose to use his middle name for fear of being targeted by immigration authorities. "No matter how you excel, the system always comes back to haunt you, to remind you that you did all of that, and yet you really don't have a choice."

A promise of work authoriza-

tion and deportation protection pulled a generation of undocumented youths out of the shadows when DACA went into effect in 2012. Yet, hundreds of thousands of today's students like Alex are largely left out because of the ongoing legal battle that has for the most part frozen applications since 2017.

These students' lives are further upended by the Trump administration's aggressive immigration enforcement strategy this year. DACA recipients and international students have been targeted, which has cast a cloud over higher edu-

[See DACA, A7]

Rams bound for Super Bowl glory

Their win over Detroit proves no opponent will beat this unstoppable team, Bill Plaschke writes. **SPORTS, B10**

Prop. 50 battle in L.A. courtroom

Republicans and Democrats square off over the state's congressional redistricting measure. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 74/50. **B6**



ROBERT F. BUKATY Associated Press

CAMPUS TRAGEDY

Visitors pause at a memorial at Brown University. Police released someone who had been a person of interest in the attack on Saturday. **NATION, A6**